Assuming you are now 25 and your current annual (essential) expenses are 2.5 L. By age 40, when you wish to retire, the *current* annual expense would shoot up to about 5.4 L (and there maybe additional expenses by then too, but we will ignore that for the moment).

Let's say your expenses start at 5.4L and increase each year by 8% (inflation). You'd need a corpus that is invested in a portfolio generating 9% return after taxes post-40. In such a case, you'd need a corpus of about 1.5 Crores by 40, that'll last you from age 40 to age 80 (you better be dead by then!).

Is it possible to get a corpus of 1.5 crores by age 40? It is quite hard because you must invest 1.25 times the annual expenses (3.06L) each year in investments that yield 11%. How ever, it is not impossible. If you have the right salary (at least 2.5+3.06L take home), you can cut your expenses drastically (public transport, no EMI) thereby allowing you to invest in huge proportions. If you can invest aggressively to this degree, you can have enough to retire early at 40 [36] . Tread with caution though, life doesn't pan out like a spreadsheet [37] . It would be better if we kept ploughing for a few more years and had enough runway to factor unexpected expenses.

"When a train goes through a tunnel and it gets dark, you don't throw away your ticket and jump off. You sit still and trust the engineer"

- Corrie Ten Boom, *Dutch watchmaker and protector of Jews during Nazi Holocaust*

While we bide our time at a corporate role, we can still do something for ourselves at present. As we charter plans for our future and make considerable contributions, we can tinker our days a little to have more independence. Enter 'Just in time' reading.

'Just In Time' vs 'Just In Case' Reading

"Life's tragedy is that we get old too soon and wise too late"

– Benjamin Franklin

I once spoke to my friend Laurie, a savvy writer for a big magazine in the US. She shared something that stood as a wake-up call. As we broke down the numbers, this is what we found: